

Chapter 45-6

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Liang Shi received the notification of her successful audition around ten o'clock at night. She was soaking her feet at the time, casually playing a mobile game.

A text message popped up from the top of the screen.

She tapped to open it—it was from the production staff, notifying her that she had gotten the role.

She immediately took a screenshot to show Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu sent a middle-aged emoji, a pink lotus flower with several sparkling words next to it: "Keep up the good work."

Liang Shi: "..."

Two seconds later, Xu Qingzhu retracted it.

【Xu Qingzhu: Well done!】

Liang Shi hadn't yet recovered from the shock of that middle-aged emoji and only sent a period
【.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Sleep early, good night.】

Liang Shi: 【Mm, sweet dreams!】

Then she shared this news with Zhao Ying, and casually asked when this production would start filming.

Zhao Ying gave a rough timeframe—about half a month—and asked if she had time.

Liang Shi gave a positive answer, then asked Zhao Ying for her address, saying she wanted to send her a peace charm¹.

Zhao Ying: "..."

She was shocked: 【You believe in that stuff?】

Liang Shi: 【Since I already went.】

Zhao Ying: 【One of life's great scams: "Since we came all this way" and "Since we already went."】

Liang Shi: 【Do you want it or not?】

Zhao Ying: 【Haicheng City Changming District Huazhou International Community Building 3 Unit 1 Room 903, 187xxx, for the gentle lovely beautiful girl. bow.jpg】

Liang Shi was amused by her: 【Okay.】

Then she asked where Zhao Xuning was. Zhao Xuning's answer was as cold as ever: 【Hospital.】

A few seconds later— 【Don't come, no beds available.】

Liang Shi: "..."

Completely speechless.jpg

She thought that when she had time, she'd go to the hospital after work to treat Zhao Xuning to a meal as thanks.

She'd received her care many times before, and Liang Shi wasn't the ungrateful type.

After finishing everything, Liang Shi finally lay down in bed.

Bedtime was her time to understand this world—commonly known as internet surfing.

She scrolled through trending topics, nothing particularly noteworthy.

But there was a recent hashtag #Yang Shuyan Universal Divine Beauty#, which when clicked showed Yang Shuyan's nine-grid² beauty photos.

She opened each one and flipped through them.

Found every single one beautiful.

...

Then under this hashtag she discovered one that wasn't so beautiful.

She tapped to save it and sent it to Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu: 【Said good night then went to browse Weibo³?】

Liang Shi: 【... Showing you a beauty.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【...】

Liang Shi: 【Without the drama's filter, she seems just so-so.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【...】

Two seconds later, Xu Qingzhu sent a screenshot of her wallpaper.

It was Yang Shuyan in her red costume from "Chang Bai," hailed by fans as "one divine image that conquers all."

Liang Shi: 【... You'll get aesthetic fatigue from looking at it every day.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【?】

Liang Shi: 【Really!】

Actually, Liang Shi had typed three exclamation marks, but before sending she felt she seemed too excited, so she deleted two.

On Xu Qingzhu's end, it kept showing "the other party is typing."

After a moment.

Xu Qingzhu: 【Really?】

Liang Shi: 【Of course!!】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Then why don't I get aesthetic fatigue from looking at you every day and looking in mirrors?】

Liang Shi: "..."

Momentarily speechless.

Xu Qingzhu sent another screenshot.

It was of their chat window.

The contact name at the top read: It's Liang Shi not Liang He⁴.

The chat background was a silhouette.

Under dim lighting, she stood in the kitchen studying the oven intently, slightly bent over, with several strands of long hair falling in front, but you could see most of her profile.

Through Xu Qingzhu's lens, she wasn't overly thin, nor was she fat, but had just the right fullness.

Breasts slightly larger than the average Alpha, buttocks more shapely than the average Alpha.

Even wearing an apron, it didn't diminish the poetry.

The filter was just right, the angle beautiful, full of atmosphere.

It immediately gave one a sense of the warmth of human life.

This image would make people exclaim in admiration even if posted on her old Weibo.

It had to be said, Xu Qingzhu was very good at photography.

For a moment, Liang Shi felt her heart filled with something.

But after two minutes of calming down, she sent: 【Secret photography of me? Hand over the original.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【?】

— 【It was open photography, you just didn't see. As for the original? Why should I give you what I took?】

Liang Shi: 【... Then you're violating my image rights.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【I didn't sell it for money.】

Liang Shi: 【...】

Xu Qingzhu: 【After you become famous, I'll hang it out to sell, should make a small profit.】

Liang Shi: 【...】

After sending two strings of ellipses, she said helplessly: 【Fine, you're right about everything.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【How could that be? Teacher Liang taught me well.】

Liang Shi: 【...】

Single since birth and having acted in very few romantic scenes, Liang Shi was now completely stumped.

Her passive-aggressive skills couldn't match Xu Qingzhu's.

Clearly, she was also better at online chatting than Xu Qingzhu.

Obviously, she was quite proper in reality.

How did she become like this online...

Liang Shi sent her: 【Keep this up and I'll come upstairs to snatch your phone.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【... Teacher Liang, you can't take a joke.】

Liang Shi: 【Yes, I'm old, can't take jokes.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【?】

Liang Shi: 【Go to bed early.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Alright, no more joking, sleep well, good night.】

But Liang Shi suddenly sat up two minutes after turning off her phone, rapidly tapping the screen:
【You use my photo as your chat background, so in exchange, shouldn't you give me one of your photos?】

Xu Qingzhu: 【... What for?】

Liang Shi: 【Fairness.】

Xu Qingzhu: 【Stunned.jpg】

A few seconds later, Xu Qingzhu sent her a white background one-inch ID photo⁵.

Liang Shi: 【.....】

Xu Qingzhu was still the most ruthless.

Footnotes: ¹ Peace charm: Traditional Chinese amulets believed to bring protection and good luck
² Nine-grid: A popular social media format where multiple photos are arranged in a 3x3 grid ³
Weibo: Chinese social media platform similar to Twitter ⁴ Liang He vs Liang Shi: A play on Chinese
characters where the names sound similar but are written differently ⁵ One-inch ID photo:
Standard format for official identification photos in China, typically very plain and formal